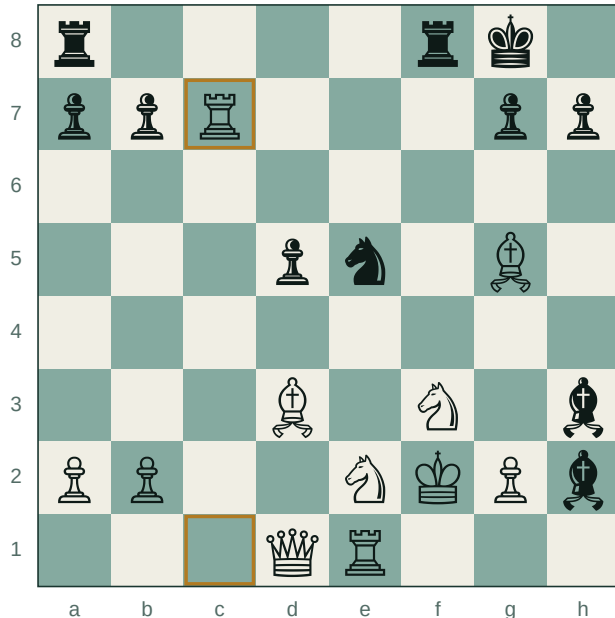


Pins and pressure: Black, move 19

Pins and pressure

Black to move



Previous move: 19.Rxc7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

19...Ng4+ 20. Kf1 Rxf3#

19...Ng4+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The changed line means the bishop on h2 attacks the rook on c7. Recorded reply: **20.Kf1**.

20...Rxf3# Mate: rook on f3 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on f1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on f3. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on f2. Absolute pin: knight on f3.